

Loss Adjuster Report

Claim CLM-2026-10001 | Harper Lane reference HLA-26-7718

Executive assessment

The reported storm was the proximate cause of sudden internal water damage after two roof tiles displaced. However, deteriorated valley sealant, debris build-up and historic moisture marking materially increased the extent of ingress. The reasonable storm-attributable building repair allowance is **AUD 24,600 including GST**. The contractor quote of AUD 38,750 includes maintenance, full-valley renewal and broader finishes not attributable solely to the event.

Instruction and inspection

Insurer	Southern Cross General Insurance (fictional)
Policy number	HHP-884291
Claim number	CLM-2026-10001
Named insured	Daniel Morgan
Risk address	42 Example Crescent, Glenhaven VIC 3999
Incident	Storm and water damage - 18 July 2026
Claim lodged	21 July 2026
Adjuster	Harper Lane Adjusting Services (fictional)
Adjuster reference	HLA-26-7718
Site inspection	24 July 2026, 10:00 am
Weather record reviewed	Fictional Glenhaven station: 41 mm rain; peak gust 86 km/h on 18 July

Causation findings

Finding	Evidence	Assessment
Tile displacement	Two fresh edge fractures and displaced tiles above rear valley	Consistent with storm wind
Valley condition	Aged sealant, debris and surface corrosion; no valley perforation	Pre-existing maintenance issue
Internal ceiling	Fresh saturation and sagging aligned with event pathway	Storm-attributable
Older marking	Faint tide mark and softened timber edge behind cornice	Likely pre-existing/gradual
Television	Water exposure plausible; no diagnostic report yet	Further evidence required

Recommended scope and allocation

Work category	Quoted	Storm allowance	Reason
Make safe / access	AUD 2,200	AUD 2,200	Necessary event response
Roof tiles and local valley work	AUD 9,800	AUD 4,900	Local storm repair covered; full renewal/maintenance excluded
Ceiling and insulation	AUD 9,350	AUD 8,900	Minor pre-existing area deducted
Drying and mould prevention	AUD 4,100	AUD 3,800	Event-related, subject to logs
Electrical testing/repair	AUD 2,450	AUD 2,450	Event-related safety work
Wall, skirting and painting	AUD 7,850	AUD 2,350	Limited to directly affected continuous area
Contingency/site costs	AUD 3,000	AUD 0	Not substantiated at assessment
TOTAL	AUD 38,750	AUD 24,600	Including GST

Coverage analysis

The storm event falls within the insured-event grant. The policy exclusions for wear and tear, gradual deterioration and maintenance apply to the aged sealant, debris clearance, pre-existing moisture damage and betterment associated with full valley replacement. They do not remove cover for separately identifiable sudden storm damage to internal finishes and local tile repairs.

Contents observations

The insured claims AUD 7,500 for the television. A supplied receipt records a purchase price of AUD 4,899 on 12 November 2023. Current equivalent replacement cost and repair viability should be confirmed. The receipt supports ownership but does not by itself establish the claimed replacement value.

Prior history and inconsistency

Claims history records a minor roof leak claim dated 3 June 2024 affecting the family-room cornice, closed after an AUD 1,180 payment. This conflicts with the claim-form answer of “No” to previous roof leaks. Clarification is recommended; the discrepancy is not, by itself, a conclusion of misrepresentation.

Recommendation

Accept the storm component in principle, reserve AUD 24,600 for building damage before the AUD 1,000 excess, seek a television diagnostic/current replacement quote, and obtain the 2024 claim file plus maintenance records before final settlement.

Prepared by	Evelyn Hart, Senior Loss Adjuster (fictional)
Report date	29 July 2026
Status	SYNTHETIC / FOR RAG TESTING ONLY